

INTERMEDIATE UNIT 10

1 Work in pairs and discuss.

- 1 Do you like travelling?
- 2 How do you prefer to travel?
- 3 What is the longest journey you've taken?

2 Read the article about travel and answer the questions.

- 1 Do engineers and scientists know what transport will be like in the future?
- 2 Do they think that train and plane travel will be faster in the future?

3 Read the article again and answer the questions.

- 1 What was the route of Concorde?
- 2 When were trains first invented?
- 3 Which country had the first high-speed trains?
- 4 How do Maglev Trains work?
- 5 What are the European countries mentioned that have high-speed trains?



In the 21st century there was a revolution in air travel and the speed and numbers of people flying increased dramatically. There was also the launch of Concorde, the **supersonic plane**, which regularly flew from London and Paris to New York in about three hours. But perhaps it's not the sky we should be looking to for faster travel but an invention of the early 19th century, the train.

Train travel **revolutionised** the transportation of **goods** and people across countries and continents, and is still a vital means of transport for people across the world. But today, thanks to modern technology, the speed of train travel has increased to unimaginable levels.

Back in the 1970s, Japan led the way with the Bullet Train. This still runs today and reaches speeds of between 300kph and 400kph. However, now even the Bullet Train has been **overtaken** by the Maglev Train, which can reach speeds of over 600kph. These trains use magnets and electricity, which means long distances can be covered very quickly.

China is leading the way in high-speed train travel and has trains that travel at around 300kph and a network that **links** major growing cities across the country. This makes train travel a strong competitor for the airlines. Trains are also considered to be a much more **environmentally friendly** form of travel.

The big question is, will other countries and continents follow this **trend** in Asia? Some countries in Europe, mainly France, Spain, Italy and Germany, already have an extensive network of high-speed trains. These already link cities and it is hoped that more of these lines will link countries, as with Eurostar that links the UK directly with Belgium and France.

So what's next? We will have to wait and see what the scientists and engineers can come up with and how fast their trains will go. Perhaps the fast train network will grow and we will be travelling at many hundreds of kilometres an hour between countries and the world will become an even smaller place.

4 Match the words and phrases in bold in the text with their meanings 1–7.

- 1 connects
- 2 changed dramatically
- 3 a way of doing something that is growing or fashionable
- 4 gone ahead
- 5 a plane that travels very fast
- 6 products
- 7 does not harm the planet

5 Work in pairs or small groups and discuss.

- 1 How do you think transport will change in the future?
- 2 Do you think driving will be easier in the future? How do you think cars will change?

6 10.1 Listen to a podcast about cars in the future and answer the questions.

- 1 What has happened to the number of cars on the road in the past twenty years?
- 2 What can software do in cars already?
- 3 What do navigation devices avoid?
- 4 What is there a race to find?
- 5 Where are electric cars mostly driven?
- 6 Why can't electric cars go long distances?

7 The words and phrases in the box are from the recording. Complete the sentences with the correct word/phrase.

batteries fuels traffic jams pollution
around the corner race

- 1 I always drive this way to avoid the _____ on my way to work.
- 2 Technology that will make space travel available to everyone is _____.
- 3 The levels of _____ in my town are high because there is a motorway nearby.
- 4 There is a _____ to find alternative energy sources before oil and gas run out.
- 5 There are different _____ you can use for heating, such as oil or gas.
- 6 Mobile phones have _____ that need charging every day.

8 Work in pairs or small groups and discuss.

- 1 Do you drive or do you want to learn to drive in the future?
- 2 Does the amount of traffic on the roads in your town/city make driving difficult?
- 3 Do you think driver-less cars are a good idea? What are the advantages and disadvantages?